

LESSON 4 — MEDIA MESSAGE ANALYSIS

Analyze messages, audience, and realism.

🎯 In this activity, you will critically analyze a media message to determine its intent, audience, and underlying logic. You will learn how to evaluate the realism of what we consume daily.



Understanding Media Literacy

Every day, we are surrounded by **media messages** from social media, advertisements, and news sites. Learning how to decode these messages helps you become a smarter, more informed consumer of information.

Term	Definition
Media Message	Any information presented through channels like videos, photos, or text that aims to inform, entertain, or persuade.
Target Audience	The specific group of people that a creator wants to reach with their message.
Subtext	The hidden or secondary meaning of a message that is not stated directly.



Read the Following Text

Read the following advertisement summary carefully. As you read, ask yourself: **Who really benefits from this message and what might they be hiding?**

Source: Advertisement Analysis

The ad features a vibrant image of a teenage athlete drinking 'HydroBoost,' a bright blue sports drink. The background shows a futuristic gym with glowing lights and advanced technology. The tagline reads: 'Unlock Your Inner Champion: Don't let anything hold you back.' The fine print notes that the drink contains 45 grams of sugar per bottle. The ad claims that '9 out of 10 elite athletes prefer HydroBoost to perform their best.' It does not mention the source of this statistic or the nutritional drawbacks of high sugar consumption for daily hydration. The ad focuses entirely on the feeling of success, confidence, and physical peak performance, ignoring the reality that most teens are not professional athletes.



Answer the Questions

Use the evidence from the advertisement description to answer the questions below.

1. What is the primary message being presented in this advertisement?

[Write your answer here.]

2. Who is the target audience for this message, and what evidence supports your choice?

3. What is missing from the message that a consumer should know?

4. Do you think the message is realistic? Why or why not?

5. Why might the creator of this ad choose to omit specific nutritional facts?

